



Shopping with VR

Forget the 'buy now' button, nod to buy that item when you shop on Alibaba with a VR headset. <http://dgit.in/AlibabaVR>



Convert RGB to Hex value

Google search now lets you convert between RGB and Hex colour values right from the search bar. <http://dgit.in/RGBHex>

Origins

or lovers of chocolate ice cream from across the world.

As of August 2016, LinkedIn has 450 million users on its platform, and is actively used by organisations to connect professionally. On the same year, MySpace came into being. Yet again a far shot from LinkedIn, MySpace



Do you remember being on Friendster?

showed the world the fun behind social media, majorly promoting music, videos and quirky graphical content that soon became wildly popular. Until the meteoric rise of Facebook, MySpace really ruled the roster of social media, until it went on a gradual decline, and now is only present as a site for musicians to share their work. MySpace was also one of the first to introduce 'Featured Content' – highlighted stories on topics, that slowly led to the rise of 'viral content'.

Mark Zuckerberg's brainchild Facebook was formed in 2004 as Harvard's in-house platform. It went public only in 2006, but by then, it was already being considered revolutionary. Facebook presently boasts over 1.3 billion users on its platform, and has an unthinkable number of features. The opening of its API and the rise of connected mobile phones gave way to third party service providers making applications, games and other services that would work within Facebook. The medium gave rise to a certain level of openness that has been the crucial factor behind its worldwide empire today. A rather different advertisement model attracted more and more businesses on to Facebook, the 'Like' button became a revolutionary synonym to emotions, and Facebook started forming the basis of statistical studies,

analyses, and 'sharing' information from one corner of the world to another was never easier.

Twitter was born in March 2006, and in response to Facebook, gave a completely different approach to social media. You could express all that you wanted, but only in 140 characters. The platform has over 300 million monthly users right now, and with the rise of mobile internet, added the aspect of instantaneous updates to the world to social media. This was not something that you partake in your pastime, but what you do on the go. Twitter was also among the first to be embraced by publications, and the format of quick headlines on the go made this platform an attractive place for corporates and college-goers alike to tune in to it.

By 2007, we had entered an era of consolidation already. Friendster had ended, people were moving from Yahoo Messenger to Google Talk, MySpace was gradually slowing down, and although LinkedIn continued on a different path, it really was Facebook and Twitter that took social media further. Frequent updates meant lesser discrepancies in usage. While Facebook was often looked upon as a platform to upload your tour experiences and express your opinions in elaborate detail, Twitter was an easy place for everyone to quickly express feelings, reach out to companies and join the public debates. Twitter is also accredited with the popularisation of hashtags, which gave rise to a fad among the youth. Hashtags became an inseparable part of everyone's lives, and the addition of emojis meant you had easier ways to express.

Amidst all of this, Orkut deserves special mention. Although not a global phenomenon and with a relatively low figure of about 100 million users at its peak, Orkut was particularly popular in Brazil and India. Google's first tryst with social media, Orkut, faded out with Facebook and Twitter's meteoric rise, and no new users could sign up since 2014. The social medium faced a number of privacy and legal issues, and although not the most refined, gave

the world a fun, casual medium to communicate with.

Google's second attempt was with Google+, a more recent phenomenon. Launched to the public in 2011, Google+ entered the world of social media after Facebook and Twitter had already consolidated their places in the industry. Google+ was built to be non-intrusive, and its live video chat feature, dubbed 'Hangouts', generated considerable hype on the Internet.

Through all of this, grew a generation of users continually attracted to social media. Platforms like Facebook and Twitter have long integrated productivity and work features, and have matured into complete platforms where important business declarations are often made. This brought content closer to people, hence giving rise to 'viral content'. Typically, viral content reaches out to millions, touching a similar chord among a vast audience. Viral stories, updates and tweets are



No prizes for guessing why he's here

shared by millions, giving birth to a world that is more spontaneous and updated with affairs.

It has also brought the world closer. From being platforms used majorly for procrastination, social media have come a long, long way, now being life-lines for people to live by.

The aftermath

As Facebook continues its domination and Twitter prevails with hilarious snippets from everyone's life, it is incredible to think that at times, the world would actually find it considerably difficult to communicate without social media. 